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README

LARP

Find your people, your events and your next role at UCL.

LARP is a web platform and mobile app for UCL students and alumni that blends professional networking with the matching mechanics of dating app. Users build a profile from their CV, choose a target role or let LARP suggest career routes, then receive a personalised feed of events, graduate roles and people worth meeting. Claude turns unstructured information (CVs, event listings, job descriptions) into structured profiles, clear recommendations and conversation starters. The aim is simple: fewer tabs, better connections and a clearer patl from where a student is to where they want to be.

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The Problem

UCL students have no shortage of opportunities. The difficulty is finding the right ones for their goals and the right people to help them ge there.

- **Fragmented sources.** Students' Union and society events, UCL Careers events and graduate job listings live on separate platforms, newsletters and group chats. Students have to search each one and work out for themselves which are relevant.
- **Weak alumni access.** Alumni who have already taken the path a student wants to follow are hard to identify and harder to approach. There is rarely an obvious, low-pressure way to start the conversation.
- **Generic networking.** Mainstream professional networks are built for everyone, so they are not tuned to a single university community Connections are driven by job titles rather than shared ambitions, interests or personality.
- **Unclear career routes.** Many students know their background but not which roles it leads to, or which steps would close the gap.

The Solution

LARP brings people, events and roles for UCL students into one place and ranks them against each user's goals.

1. **Build a profile** by uploading a CV or entering your background manually. Add your personality type and hobbies if you wish.
2. **Set a direction** by naming the role you want, or let LARP suggest career routes based on your background.
3. **Get a tailored feed** of SU and society events, UCL Careers events and graduate roles that move you towards that goal.
4. **Meet the right people** by connecting with students and alumni who share your ambitions, background or interests. Follow people for their hobbies as well as their careers.

Every recommendation comes with a short, plain-language explanation of why it was suggested.

Context

The Hackathon

LARP is being built for the **Claude Campus Hackathon + Showcase**, run by **UCL Entrepreneurs × Claude Builder Club UCL**.

Detail	Information
Date	Friday 16 October 2026, 4pm to 7pm
Venue	Jeffery Hall, UCL IOE, 20 Bedford Way
Track	Better Student Life
Team size	Up to four UCL students
Format	Building starts before the event, with about 1.5 hours of building on the day before demos are judged
Submission deadline	6:20pm UK time on the day, via the organisers' form
Submission contents	Demo video, slides, PDF or walkthrough and an optional GitHub link

Track fit: Better Student Life. The track asks teams to build something with Claude that makes student life easier, more enjoyable or mor connected. LARP addresses this directly:

- **More connected.** Students meet peers and alumni who share their goals and interests, not just their course.
- **Easier discovery.** Career events, society events and graduate roles are collected in one feed and ranked against each student's chosen direction.
- **Built with Claude.** Claude handles CV parsing, career route suggestions, recommendation explanations, summaries and conversation starters.

University College London

University College London (UCL) was founded in 1826 in Bloomsbury, London. It was the first university in England to admit students regardless of their religion and among the first to admit women on equal terms with men. Today it is a multidisciplinary research university spanning the arts, sciences, engineering, medicine and social sciences.

UCL School of Management

The UCL School of Management is UCL's business school. It sits within the Faculty of Engineering Sciences and is based at One Canada Square in Canary Wharf. Its teaching and research focus on analytics, technology, innovation and entrepreneurship.

MSc Business Analytics

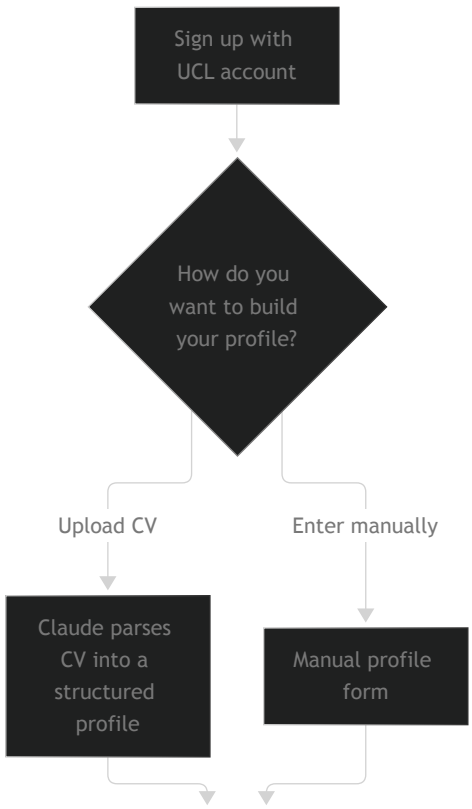
The MSc Business Analytics programme at the UCL School of Management combines data science and technology with management, preparing students to use data to analyse problems and inform business decisions.

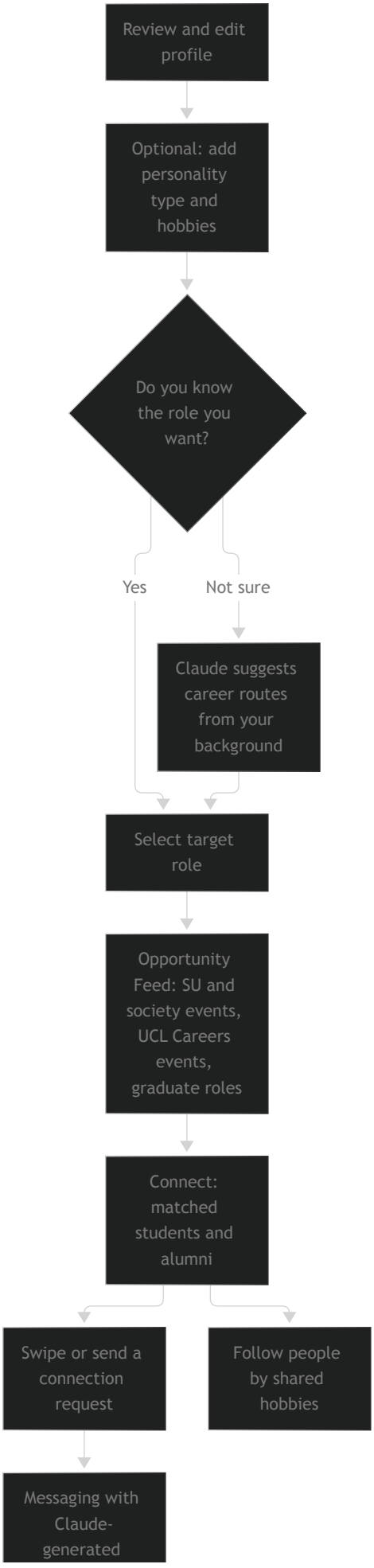
The Team

We are four MSc Business Analytics students at the UCL School of Management.

Name	Role
Tomas Truyols	Product Manager

User Journey




Review and edit profile
Optional: add personality type and hobbies
Do you know the role you want?
Yes
Not sure
Claude suggests career routes from your background
Select target role
Opportunity Feed: SU and society events, UCL Careers events, graduate roles
Connect: matched students and alumni
Swipe or send a connection request
Follow people by shared hobbies
Messaging with Claude-generated

conversation starters



Product Modules

Profile Builder

Purpose: create a rich, structured profile with as little effort as possible.

- CV upload (PDF or DOCX) with Claude-powered parsing into education, experience, skills and interests
- Manual entry for users without a CV or who prefer to type
- Review and edit step so users stay in control of what is saved
- Optional personality type (for example a self-reported framework of the user's choice)
- Hobbies and non-work interests

Career Route Engine

Purpose: turn a profile into a clear career direction.

- Target role selection from a searchable list
- AI-suggested career routes based on the user's background, each with a short rationale
- Gap summary showing skills or experience that would strengthen an application
- Ability to save several routes and switch between them

Opportunity Feed

Purpose: surface the events and roles that matter for the chosen route.

- Students' Union and society events
- UCL Careers events, fairs and workshops
- Graduate roles and jobs from external job platforms
- Ranking against the user's target role and interests
- Short Claude-generated summaries and a "why this was recommended" explanation for each item

Connect

Purpose: introduce users to students and alumni worth knowing.

- Matching on shared career goals, profile similarity and interests
- Swipe-based or request-based connection, chosen by the user
- Mutual opt-in before messaging is unlocked
- Follow people based on non-work interests such as hobbies
- Explanation of why each match was suggested

Messaging and Notifications

Purpose: keep conversations and opportunities moving.

- One-to-one messaging between connected users
- Claude-generated conversation starters based on shared ground
- Notifications for new matches, messages, upcoming events and new roles on a saved route
- User-controlled notification preferences

How Claude Powers LARP

LARP uses the **Anthropic API** to call Claude for the following tasks.

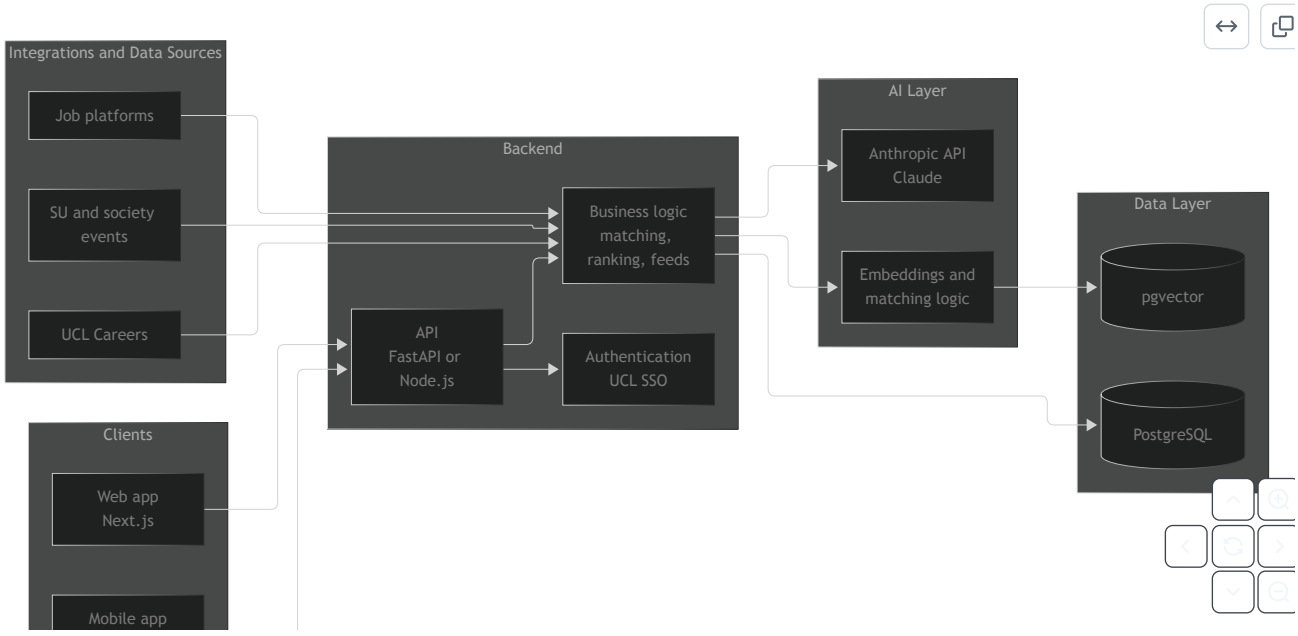
Task	Input	Output
CV parsing	Uploaded CV text	Structured profile (education, experience, skills, interests) as JSON
Career route generation	Structured profile	Ranked career routes with rationale and skill gaps
Recommendation explanations	Profile plus a match, event or role	A short, plain-language reason for the recommendation
Event and job summaries	Event or job listing text	A concise summary highlighting what is relevant to the user
Conversation starters	Two connected profiles	Suggested opening messages based on shared ground

Design principles:

- **Structured outputs.** Claude returns JSON against defined schemas so results can be validated and stored.
- **Human in the loop.** Users review parsed profiles and suggested routes before they are used for matching.
- **Explainability.** Every recommendation shown to a user is accompanied by a reason.
- **Data minimisation.** Only the fields needed for each task are sent to the API.

System Architecture

> No code exists in the repository yet, so the stack below is **proposed** and may change.



Frontend

- **Web app:** Next.js (proposed)
- **Mobile app:** React Native with Expo (proposed)
- **Shared design system** so both clients look and behave consistently

Backend

- REST API serving both clients (proposed: Python FastAPI or Node.js)
- Authentication and session management
- Business logic for profiles, career routes, feed ranking, matching and messaging

Data Layer

- **PostgreSQL** for users, profiles, events, roles, connections and messages (proposed)
- **pgvector** to store embeddings of profiles, events and roles for similarity-based matching (proposed)

AI Layer

- Anthropic API integration for parsing, generation, summarisation and explanations
- Versioned prompt templates with defined output schemas
- Embedding generation for profiles, events and roles
- Matching logic that combines vector similarity with explicit filters (target role, interests, availability)

Integrations and Data Sources

- Students' Union and society events
- UCL Careers events
- Graduate roles and jobs from external job platforms

All external data must come from **official APIs, feeds or partnerships**. Scraping platforms such as LinkedIn breaches their terms of servic and is out of scope. For the hackathon demo, LARP uses seeded sample data.

Authentication

UCL single sign-on (SSO) is proposed so that the platform stays UCL-only and users are verified as current students or alumni.

Infrastructure and Deployment

- **Hosting:**
- **CI/CD:** automated linting, tests and deployment on merge to `main`
- **Configuration:** environment variables for all keys and connection strings. No secrets are committed to the repository; `.env` files are git-ignored and a `.env.example` documents the required variables.

Business Plan

Target Users

Group	Who they are
Students	Undergraduate and postgraduate students at UCL
Alumni	UCL graduates willing to share experience and advice
Societies	Student societies and the Students' Union promoting events
UCL Careers	The university's careers service promoting events and resources
Employers	Organisations recruiting UCL graduates and interns

Value Proposition

Group	Value
Students	One place to find relevant events, roles and people, ranked against their own goals
Alumni	An easy, low-effort way to give back and stay connected with UCL
Societies	Better reach to students who are genuinely interested in their events
UCL Careers	Higher engagement with careers events and insight into student ambitions
Employers	Access to motivated, well-matched candidates and better-attended employer events

Competitive Landscape

Alternative	Strength	Gap LARP addresses

LinkedIn	Large professional network	Not tuned to a single university community; connections driven by job titles
Handshake	Student-focused jobs and employer events	Limited emphasis on peer and alumni matching or non-work interests
Bumble BFF / Bizz-style apps	Engaging, low-pressure matching	Not career-focused and not tied to a university
UCL's own careers tools	Official, trusted source of careers events and support	Separate from society events and peer networking; not personalised around a matched network

Differentiation: LARP is UCL-only, combines career and non-career matching, ranks opportunities against a chosen career route and explains every recommendation using Claude.

Revenue Model Options

- **Freemium:** core features free for students, with optional premium features (for example extended route analysis)
- **Employer partnerships:** paid access to promote roles and employer events to well-matched users
- **Sponsored events:** promoted placement for society or employer events, clearly labelled
- **University licence:** institutional licence for careers services and alumni relations teams

Go-to-Market

1. **Launch at UCL** through societies and the Students' Union, starting with a small group of societies as early partners.
2. **Grow the alumni side** through alumni networks and UCL School of Management contacts.
3. **Partner with UCL Careers** to bring official events into the feed.
4. **Expand to other universities** once engagement and retention are proven at UCL.

KPIs

KPI	Definition
Activation	Share of sign-ups who complete a profile and choose a career route
Connections made	Number of mutual connections per active user
Event sign-ups	Event registrations originating from the Opportunity Feed
Applications started	Job or graduate role applications started from LARP
Retention	Share of users active after 7, 30 and 90 days

Privacy, Ethics and Compliance

- **UK GDPR.** LARP processes personal data under UK GDPR. A lawful basis, privacy notice and data protection impact assessment are required before launch.
- **Consent for CV and personality data.** Users explicitly consent before a CV is processed or a personality type is stored. Personality data is optional.
- **Transparency about AI.** Users are told when Claude processes their data and can review all outputs before they are saved.
- **Visibility controls.** Users choose which profile fields are visible and to whom. They can also opt out of matching entirely.
- **Safety features.** Blocking, reporting and mutual opt-in before messaging. Reports are reviewed by a moderator.
- **Fairness in matching and route suggestions.** Protected characteristics are not used as matching inputs. Route suggestions are base on skills and experience, and outputs are reviewed for bias against particular backgrounds.
- **Data retention.** Uploaded CVs are deleted after parsing unless the user chooses to keep them. Users can export or delete their account and data at any time.

Hackathon MVP vs Roadmap

Area	MVP demo (16 October 2026)	Later phases
Profile Builder	CV upload, Claude-generated structured profile, manual edit	Personality type, hobbies, richer manual entry
Career Route Engine	Claude-suggested career routes from the parsed profile	Gap analysis, saved routes, target role search
Opportunity Feed	Sample feed of events and roles from seeded data, with explanations	Live SU, society, UCL Careers and job platform integrations
Connect	Sample match feed of seeded profiles, with explanations	Swipe and request flows, following by hobbies, embedding-based matching
Messaging and Notifications	Claude-generated conversation starter for a sample match	Full messaging and push notifications
Platform	Web app only	Mobile app, UCL SSO, production hosting and moderation

Repository Structure

The repository is currently empty. The proposed structure is:

```
LARP-Project/
├── frontend-web/     # Next.js web app
├── mobile/           # React Native (Expo) mobile app
├── backend/          # API, authentication and business logic
├── ai/               # Prompt templates, schemas, embeddings and matching logic
├── data/             # Seeded sample data for the demo
├── docs/             # Architecture notes, diagrams and design decisions
├── business/         # Business plan, pitch slides and research
├── .env.example      # Required environment variables (no secrets)
└── README.md
```

Getting Started

> These steps are placeholders until the codebase is in place.

Prerequisites

1. Clone the repository

```
git clone <!-- TODO: repository URL -->
cd LARP-Project
```

2. Install dependencies

```
# TODO: confirm commands once the stack is chosen
cd frontend-web && npm install
cd ../backend && pip install -r requirements.txt
```

3. Set environment variables

Copy `.env.example` to `.env` and fill in the values. Never commit `.env`.

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=your-key-here
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://user:password@localhost:5432/larp
# TODO: add any further variables
```

4. Run locally

```
# TODO: confirm commands once the stack is chosen
# Backend
cd backend && uvicorn main:app --reload
# Web app
cd frontend-web && npm run dev
```

Team and Contributions

Name	Role	Contributions
Tomas Truyols	Product Manager	

Licence